Saalabhanjika
Studio for Arts & Performances

Devadaasyam

Consecration to art

National Kuchipudi WorkShop 2013

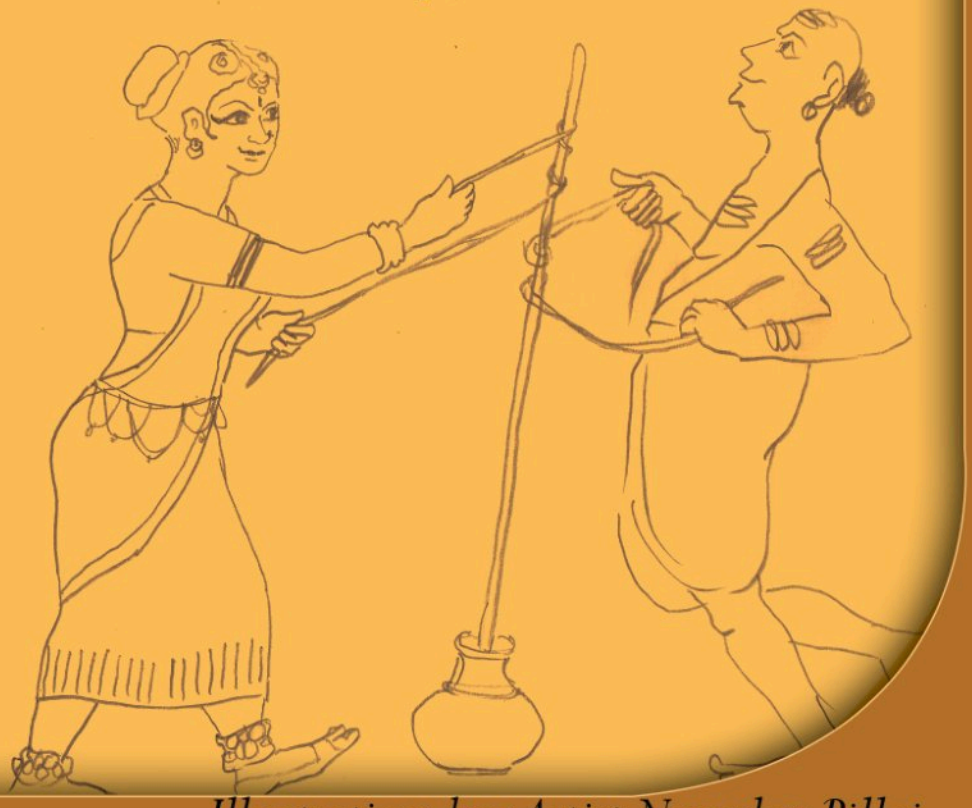
Devadaasyam

Gollakalaapam

Manual

Prepared By :
Pattathil Dhanya Menon





Illuatrations by : Artist Nanadan Pillai

Devadaasyam
Consecration to Art
National Kuchipudi workshop at
Naatyagruham
Kerala Sangeetha Nataka Academy,Thrissur
May 2 , 3 , 4 , 2013

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PREFACE



As cultural dimensions, aesthetic sensibility keep changing, it is inevitable that any society needs to accept the corresponding reflects of the same. This is true for all art forms too. Thus, we need to Preserve, Transform and Transfer the 'Visions encoded in the Art forms' to the forthcoming generations. However, preservation of certain eternal value systems need to be ensured, assuring that time bound essential transformations do not distort the ultimate and core objectives. If not carefully monitored, any experimentation and alteration can be hazardous to the upcoming generations. The great sage, Bharata has repeatedly underlined this truth in his Naatyashasthra.

My small experience as a dance performer made me realize the message encoded in the wisdom of Bharata and I wish to strongly abide by it. As a cyber crime investigator too, I could deduce the prime reason for the disfiguration of the youngsters' culture is the lack of awareness of the great repository of value systems, also innate in our Arts, I found the ancient Devadaasi system that existed as a substratum to many of the art forms we are familiar with today, need to be preserved, essentially for their aesthetic values, sense of devotion to the higher powers and commitment to the society. I feel blessed to have found that sizable literature and resource persons do exist even now in robust conditions. Annabattula Lakshmi Mankamma Thayuru is a legendary Guru in the Kuchipudi Devadasi style, who hails from Mummidivaaram village of Andhra Pradesh & belongs to the 6th generation of the Devadaasi style; the last living link in this style. A workshop was thus planned, requesting her to be the resource person, for which I prepared a Manual for the participants to carry and work more on it.

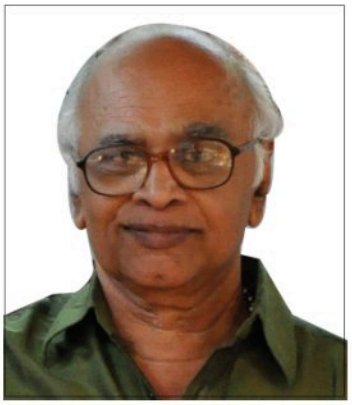
I express my deep felt gratitude to all my gurus, office bearers, faculty and staff of 'Ssap' and 'Org-people' for the immense motivation, guidance and cooperation that resulted in the structuring of this manual. I take this opportunity to record my deep sense of gratitude to my parents and members of the family for being with me and guiding me in each and every step I take.

Pattathil Dhanya Menon

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FOREWORD



It is my immense pleasure and privilege to write a preface for the Mannual, 'Gollakalaapam'. Brought out by the Saalabhanjika Studio for Arts and Performance (Ssap) and Orgpeople, Trissur, it is guide line to the students and aspirants of the traditional Kuchipudi style of audio-visual performance. Targeted to the prospective students of the specific workshop, Devadaasyam – Consecration to Art, scheduled on 2nd to the 4th of May, 2013, the said manual contains the text and guidelines to enact the preface to the story, 'Golla kalaapam'. It unfolds the techniques in the Poorvarangam (the audio-visual preface to the presentation of a drama) as prescribed in the Bharata's Naatya -shaastra, the hitherto unparalleled compendium on Indian theatrics.

The performance manual contains the details of the text (transliterated from Telugu to English) that deals with the entrance ad dialogues between a milkmaid, who belongs to the Yaadava tribe and a scholastic Brahmin. Having read the text, I felt it has striking similarities to the incident, Chandaalaguru darshanam' as found in the legends and stories related to the life and works of Sree Aadi Sankarachaarya. It tells us, the highest among scholars of any time too, at times, have to get their inner eyes opened to the eternal wisdom, by the otherwise uneducated laymen or women.

I wish to record, with no hesitation, that the manual is a timely spark to kindle more wicks that carry powerful flames to enlighten the seekers in the field of Naatya. I congratulate Ms. Pattathil Dhnaya Menon, the Director, Ssap, for having taken enough pains to locate the said text and prepare the manual with the help of her teachers. None less is the work done by Artist Nandan Pillai, Director, Orgpeople, in giving intense support to the entire cause, also in the form of the line drawings found in the manual. This foreword is a Consecration to the work that serves for the cause of Arts. I pray to the Almighty that Ssap and Orgpeople succeed in all their future endeavours too.

C P. Unnikrishnan

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Tarigonda Vengamamba was a poetess and staunch devotee of Lord Venkateswara in the 18th century. She wrote numerous poems and songs. Vengamamba was born into a family of Nandavareeks sect of Brahmins in 1730 A.D. Her father was Krishnayamatya and mother , Mangamamba. Since childhood, she was an ardent devotee of Lord Venkateswara and her devotion made the villagers believe that she was insane.



She was married at a very early age (common practice in those times,) Having lost her husband Venkatachalapathi at a very young age Vengamamba became a child-widow. However, she refused to accept anyone but the Lord, as her husband and continued to dress as a married woman(such as wearing mangalsutra, colourful clothing, bottu/bindi etc.).She studied yoga sciences under Acharya (professor) Subrahmnayudu and became a yogini. As a result, she faced resentment of the local priest in Tarikonda, and shifted to Tirumala. The priest and descendants of Annamayya who had heard of her devotion welcomed her

Moved by her devotion, it is said, that Lord Venkateswara allowed her to enter the temple after the temple hours to listen to poems and songs. Venkamamba recited poems and took 'Aarathi' of the Lord each night and paid pearls as her offering to the Lord. Observing pearls in the sanctum sanctorum over a period of time, the 'priests' investigation led to Venkamamba. Their punishment was to exile her to a cave in Tumburakona, at a distance of fifteen miles from Tirumala.

The legend goes on to say that Lord Venkateswara created a secret passage from the cave to the temple which was used by Venkamamba to continue her devotional service. The practice of penance and night Aarathi continued for six years. Eventually, the priests realized their folly , recognized Venkamamba's devotion and dedication, and requested her to return. Upon return, she was allowed to participate in Ekanta seva and take the final Aarathi of the Lord.The area around her samādhi was later converted into a school with the samadhi still open for pilgrims' worship in the school's playground.

Her first works are, :
Tarigonda Nrusimha Satakam, Nrusimha Vilasa Katha, Siva Natakam and Balakrishna Natakam

The above works are in the Yakshaganam style. These works Rajayogamrutha Saram, a Dwipada Kavyam .

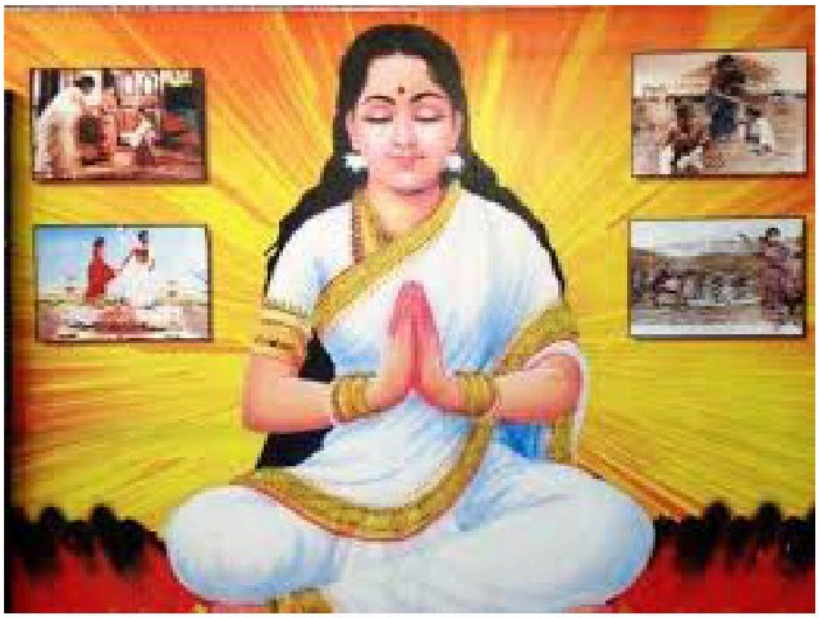
were completed when she was in Tarikonda.

On her return to Tirumala from Tumburakona caves, Venkamamba wrote :

Vishnu Parijatham,
Chenchu Natakam ,
Rukmini Natakam and
Jala Krida Vilasam and
Mukthi Kanthi Vilasam (all Yaksha Ganams), Gopi Natakam (Golla Kalapam-Yakshaganam),

Rama Parinayam,
Sri Bhagavatham,
Sri Krishna Manjari,
Tatva Keerthanalu and
Vashista Ramayanam (Dwipada),
Sri.Venkataachala Mahatyam (Padya Prabhandam) and
Ashtanga Yoga,Saram (Padyakruthi).

Since the Lord accepted Venkamamba's devotion, her Aarathi has been incorporated into Ekanta Seva performed for the Lord each night. A descendent of Venkamamba pays pearls as fee and the Aarathi is called Venkamamba's Aarathi.



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HISTORY OF KUCHIPUDI DANCE FORM

Kuchipudi, one of the oldest south Indian classical dance forms, had its origin at Kuchelapuram village, of the Krishna district in Andrapradesh. The name kuchipudi had its origin from the word Kuchelapuram. Devadasi style is the oldest form in Kuchipudi. In ancient days, this art form was presented in a dance drama style and used to take two or three days for completing a play. This was then dominated by male artists. In the recent times, this traditional style is almost fading away and presentations which lasted of 2-3 days are being compressed to 2/3 hours. In the Devadasi style, dialogue presentation is also an important task of the dancer. In addition to the dancer, there used to be a conductor who moves along with the performer.



The well known dance dramas in Kuchipudi are "Bhama Kalaapam " and "Golla Kalaapam". Golla kalaapam is based on arguments between a milk man and a Brahmin, whereas, Bhama Kalapam, is a full and complete depiction of the character of SathyaBhama.



The devadasi style of kuchipudi is one among the oldest and fading temple dance form which has deep roots in Indian culture.



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SAALABHANJIKA PROFILE

Saalabhanjika Studio for arts and performance is an institution specialised in imparting training in South Indian classical art forms to budding artists. Our vision is to develop it into a world class organization, extending training in both theory and practice of each branch of fine arts. The primary objective is to enhance the quality of communication in the media related to histrionics and to reintegrate Learning and Research to the presentation, performance and application of Dance.

The Workshop – Principal Objectives:

Preservation, Transformation and Transfer are three essential processes that maintain any stable culture. We need to begin from the Past, move through the Present with a clear vision into the Future. The loss of several cultural complements has made sociological balance a task difficult to be reinstated. As an attempt to prevent further loss and spread the importance of the subject, the 3 day-long workshop would focus on an analysis and teaching of the Devadasi style of Kuchipudi. The Devadasi style of Kuchipudi is one among the oldest and fading temple-dance forms with pertinent reflections of the Indian culture, extending their roots into past centuries. The procedures during the 3 days will observe the ancient system and the transitions it has made through, till the present.

Contents Proposed for the Workshop:

a) An introduction to the theoretical background of the Devadasi style of Kuchipudi and its significance to the present scenario; a comparative study between the ancient style and the present one will be made during the workshop.
b) Teaching of The Golla Bhama's Pravesa Daruvu. This is an item that introduces the Golla-Bhama.
c) Since the tradition in Devadasi style is a dance drama pattern, the elements of drama,known in the system, would also be taught during the 3 day sessions.

This workshop will be beneficial to:

a) Dance students
b) Researchers in dance
c) Those interested in using dance & theatre as applied subjects
d) Theater artists
e) Researchers in visual media and theater arts
f) Journalists and writers.

The aim of the workshop is to impart theoretical and practical knowledge of the Devadasi style of Kuchipudi and thereby revive the ancient style which is almost fading away.
Kuchipudi, one of the oldest south Indian classical dance forms, had its origin at Kuchelapuram village, of the Krishna district in Andrapradesh. The name kuchipudi had its origin from the word Kuchelapuram. Devadasi style is the oldest form in Kuchipudi. In ancient days, this art form was presented in a dance drama style and used to take two or three days for completing a play. This was then dominated by male artists. In the recent times, this traditional style is almost fading away and presentations which lasted 2-3 days are being compressed to 2 or 3 hours. In the Devadasi style, dialogue presentation is also an important task of the dancer. In addition to the dancer, there used to be

a conductor who moved along with the performer.The well known dance dramas in Kuchipudi are "Bhama Kalaapam " and "Golla Kalaapam". Golla Kalaapam is based on arguments between a milk-maid and a Brahmin, whereas, Bhama Kalaapam, is a full and complete depiction of the character of Sathyabhama.

They Guide:

Annabattula Lakshmi Mangathayuru is a legendary Guru in the Devadasi style of this art form. She hails from Mummidivaaram village of Andhra Pradesh. Annabattula Lakshmi Mangathayuru belongs to the 6th generation of the Devadasi style. She is the last living link in this style. Annabattula Buli Venkata Ratnam, grandmother of Annabattula Lakshmi Mangathayuru is the person who initiated the growth of this dance form, from the village to the outside world. Annabattula Sathyabhama, mother of Annabattula Lakshmi Mangathayuru was the main vocalist in the style. Grandmother, Buli Venkata Ratnam was the guru of Annabattula Lakshmi Mangathayuru,who started learning , practicing and performing dance from an early stage of her life. She has conducted a number of workshops on the present subject. She is also the visiting professor at the Andhra Pradesh University. She has received the Ugadi Puraskar 2010 and Pottu Sri. Ramalu Telugu University Lalitha Kala Puraskar.

Prof. C.P. Unnikrishnan, a known Naatyashasthraguru is a scholar in Bharata's Naatyashasthra, Kathakali-vesham performer and researcher in Indian Performing Arts. He was a teacher and a researcher in the faculty of Human Physiology in Bombay University and later became a life science teacher. His mission is to share with discerning ones, the awareness he has gathered on various aspects of Bharata's Naatyashasthra,expecially, the body kinetics of performing arts. Being well versed in the theoretical and technical aspects of classical dances, he has many lyrical compositions and choreographed works to his credit. Painting, writing and photography are his intimate passions. He has made and exhibited 48 faces of Kathakali,using Digital Technology. He is a strong propagator of the subject – "Learn Art to Learn to Learn".

Artist Nandan Pillai, is simply stupendous, as an artist. His creations are worth a million words. Nandan Pillai believes "Art is the signature of civilization and is the literacy of heart." True to his thoughts Pillai has dedicated his time and energy for the people and the mother earth. He loves nature; he loves the earth around him and also makes others feel his passions through his unique creations.The intrinsic love towards nature has impelled him to fight against the unhindered abuse of the environment. He developed a portal called "Online Art Club" for young and budding artists in the year 2000 and had 10000 members in it. This was even before Orkut or Facebook was known . He and his organisation - "Orgpeople" are the official promoters of community policing in Kerala and many other states. Pappu Zebra Road Sense Program and Uncle Dash Baby Pom fire safety Program are just to name a few.

Pattathil Dhanya Menon, who got initiated in to the world of dancing at the age of three, gradually flourished into a well seasoned Kuchipudi and Mohiniyattom dancer. Her tutelage has been under Guru Kalamandalam Kalyanikuttyamma, Kalamandalam Subhadra & RLV. Aysha Sasidharan in Mohiniyattom. Her specialization in Kuchipudi has been under the legendary performer, Annabattula Lakshmi Mangathayaru and Smt. Rama Vaani Sundari. Dhanya had her lessions in Abhinaya from Guru Smt. Brigha Bessel (Dancer and Abhinaya Exponant) and in the theory of Dance from Naatyaguru Prof. C.P.Unnikrishnan. She is also a noted Cyber Crime Investigator (Central and State Govt. Consultant).

Manikketh Venugopal Menon, a native of Ernakulam, later settled with his family in Thrissur. He graduated in Zoology from Sree Kerala varma college,Thrissur(Kerala University) in 1969. He worked for commercial firms in Mumbai and later joined the United Bank of India in 1970. He completed his JCAIIB also. During his service in the bank he worked in different states in India and opted voluntary retirement in the grade of Deputy regional Manager in 2001. After retirement he joined M/s Avanzo Cyber Security Solutions (P)Ltd., as its full time director. He is also one of the trustees of the Avanzo charitable Trust. He is involved in many social activities and is the treasurer of Sree Thrikulasekharapuram Kshethra Kshema Sangham, Annakara.

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FACULTY PROFILE

Annabattula Lakshmi Mangathayaru, hails from the family of devadasi's who have been following the presentation of Golla Kalaapam in its native version. She is the last dancer to follow the tradition in her family. She is reported to be the last living legend in the Registered kuchipudy Dancer In The Devadasi style.

She belongs to the 6th generation of the Devadasi clan who were summoned from Nelappili in Yanam district to Mummidivaram to perform as part of the daily temple rituals at the Uma Suryeswara Temple.

Her grandmother Annabattula Buli Venkita Ratnam and her mother Annabathula Sathyabhama were her Gurus. She was initiated to dancing with her sister Annabathula Leela Sai under the Sivalaya tradition of initiation at a very tender age.

Under the Sivalaya tradition of initiation children are taught the adavus for a long time till they master the foot work. Later, Padams and the Jawilis were taught by the women in the family, whereas the more difficult items like the Sabdhams, Dasavatharam etc. were taught by the men. It is only after the children have mastered to internalize the bhaava and reproduce the same with grace, they were taught the Kalaapams like Golla kalaapam and Bhaama Kalaapam. Golla Kalaapam also demands a certain amount of theoretical knowledge as it has a bit of Sanskrit in it.



Annabattula Buli venkita Venkita Ratnam



Annabattula Buli venkita Venkita Ratnam and Annabathula Sathyabhama

Annabathula Leela Sai is the vocalist who accompanies Mangathayaru in all her performances.

The sisters today run a dance school at Mummidivaram and teach students the age old traditional scripts with vigour.

Mangathayuru also works as a visiting professor in Andhra university

They are accompanied by Challa Hemasree, Mangathayuru's student.



Annabathula Lakshmi Mangathayura and Annabathula Leela Sai in their Practice Session

Annabathula Lakshmi Mangathayura has received :the honour,

Ugadhi Puraskar2010 and the
Lalithakala puraskar from Potu Sreeramulu Telugu university.



Annabathula Lakshmi Mangathayura
and Annabathula Leela Sai

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GOLLA KALAAPAM

Characters:-

1 . Viprulu- a Brahmin.

2 . Gollabhaama- a milkmaid.

Golla kalappam has 5 Ghattams or parts:-

1 VinikkiGhattam – Introduction to Golla Ghattam

2 . Yagna Ghattam – Explains the importance of yagna or rituals

3 . Pindothpathi- Deals with the philosophy of be - hind the formation of the human body.

4 . Thripurasura Samharam was performed initially for around 10 to 12 hrs. The text was lost due to lack of documentations. Now, the only available version is the one that was orally handed over to Annabattula Lakshmi Mangathayuru by her grandmother. Earlier, he script had lot of comic lines and verses too. But the current version lacks that



Slokam:- (Hayagreeva sthuthi) : Naata

Hayagreeva is the deity with a horse's head

The deity conceived by shri. Vedanta Desika in the13th century isLakshmana temple at in Khajuraho is an embodiment of great wisdom, as an incarnation of the Lord Vishnu. Hence, his consert is Devi Lekshmi.The Avataradina is celebrated on the Mahanavami day.Prayers & offerings bring knowledge, wisdom, improvement in memory, studies, removal of lazines,ignorance etc.

Jnaaanaananda – one who imparts the pleasure of knowledge

Mayam devam – My Deva

Ikada mohanaagi

Thelisindhi Gollabhaama?

Gb:Anthatta neenu

Bhrahma devunikki

Namaskarinchi - "Deva"

Nannu Srishtinchuttakku

Kaaranam eam ani

Adugaga, o! mohanaangi

Neevu Repala vaadalo

Chandra bhooyennetha

Padma Gandhi anu

Golla kaantha garbhamunna

Janmenchunnnu,nee thoodane

Vaari mandalo

Kapilaavu garbhamunna

Kamadhenuvu puttunnu

Aa kamadhenu

Paalu peruggu chella,

Gruthamulu ichunnu

Avineevu pathinaalu

Bhuvanamulalo unnavarikki

Ammumanuchu annathichi

Anthardhaanamundenu

E kaaranamunache

E paalu, perugu challal-

Ammuchunaanayya

And then I bowed before Lord Brhma and adsked him – " Oh Lord why have you created me"? To that the Lord answered – "Oh! Mohanangi, in the days to come, in the place called Repalavaadal, in the Moon Dynasty, you will be born in the womb of a Yadava woman called Padmagandhi. With you amongst them, Kamadhenu will be born to Kapila. That Kaamadhenu will give you milk and from it you shall make curd, buttermilk, butter etc. You should sell these products to the people in the all 14 worlds and make them happy. That is the reason I am selling this milk, curd, buttermilk etc. and not because my house is made of gold.

Naa illu bangaaram kaanu

V: antharikke bangaaram adhikatharolo perugijoothundi Gollabhama

No wonder the price of gold is going up always

Maatallu

Gb:Aa ayamaru,inthekki,

Inthekki,inthekki

Meeroorayye?

Oh revered, for all this, for all this, who are you?

V: Asanta,asanta,

Ippattake mam aveeremmo

Theluskonaleni kuthoohalam

Kalisinthi Gollabhaamakki

Golla bhaama,memu

Bhrahmanullu

Stay away, stay away.
And now Gollabhaama wants to know who I am .
We are Brahmins

Gb:oraya ooraya,

Who? Who?

V:Bhrahmanullu

Brahmins

Gb:vyaamalla?

"Vyamalas?"

V:Yamamallammu leathu,

Mamallamu leathu.

Gollabhaamakki,

Not vyamals or mamals. Gollab-haama cannot even pronounce properly?

Nooru thiragattam lenattuga

Untadi

Gb:Gollanvallam Kethettaiyya

Veri gollavaarikki

We are after all only cowherds. And, we cannot pronounce prop-erly.

Nooru thirapathu

Kathattayya?

V:Marokke naamadheyam

Chepthaanu vinu,

Golla bhaama

Viprullam,pappu thine

Viprullam.

I will tell you one more name. Gollabhaama we are priests; priests who eat cereals.

Gb:upparlaa?

Vodi upperlaa?

Vaadi upparlaa?

Upparla – low caste. Do u belong to this low caste or that low cast?

V:Eavitti Gollabhaama

Upparlanttunaavu?

Vaallu,noothulu,

Sonthullu thavutharu

What is this Gollabhaama? You are calling me low caste? They make wells and drains. When the time come we only clean houses.

Meamu Samayam osthe,kompalne

Thavesthu unttamu

3rd character - this was once said by someone in the audience. Now this is done by the play back singer.

Eatandi

Anadhanigaaro

Kompaalu thaavadam

What is it that you mean by cleansing houses?

Eantandi?

V: Nithya agnihothram

Kathandi?

Inttilone homakunttam

Veyyali,mari thavvodu

We have big rites like Nityaagnihothram. So then we should clean houses as we have to do the rites in the house itself.

Gb:Aa,ayavaaru,

Oh! revered one!

V:Eqmiti Gollabhaama?

Yes Gollabhaama?

ab:Jaathini baapalenattaya?

Are you a Brahmin by caste?

v:Jaathini bhrahmaname

Yes Brahmin by caste

ab:Varnane baapalenattaya?

Are u a Brahmin by colour?

V:Varnaani bhrahmaname

Yes Brahmin by colour

ab:Kullaane baapalenattaya?

Are u a Brahmin by creed?

V:Kullani bhrahmaname

Yes Brahmin by creed.

V:Vari Gollabhamane

Annipinchukunnaavu

Gollabhama

Jaathanna,kullammanna,

Varnamanna,okatte

You proved that you are a unintelligent cowherd. Caste, colour and creed means all the same

Gb:Jaathi bhaapantte

Aa vaade meethi

Ochindi

Neeve nattu ayya?

If you are a Brahmin by caste, have you come here by that ship?

V:Aaa vaadalavi

Memi ekkamu golla

Bhaama,maakku

Matha acharallu ekkuva

Antaipoomu ma menatha

Mena mama kodukku

Okkadu unaadule

Vaadu a vodalavi

Ekkuthu thiguthu

Unttaadu

Aaa, we don't get into ships. We have llots of rites and rituals to follow. Ok, one of my relatives used to climb up a rock and roll it down again over and over again.

Gb:Aa,ayyavari,

Inthekki,meeru

Evarayye?

Oh revered one!, for all this, who are you?

V:Malli mothattike

Ocheevu?

You have come back to the same question again

Viprullam(bhrahmanulu)

Gb:Meeru baapelaithe

Veda,vihithamulaina

Nithya,nrimithika

Karmalu cheesthunaaru

Ettaya?

If you are Brahmins are you doing your rites and duties according to the vedas?

V:Avami eppudo

Odilesam Gollabhaama

We have left all that long ago Gollabhaama

Gb:Mee baapalantha

Puttett appudu

Sroodulu gaane

Puttinaaru kathattaiye?

All you brahmins when born, are born as Shudras itself right?

V: Ha! brahmanulu

Antha puteetapudu

Surupuga putteera?

Ha! What? Brahmins are all born as shoodras? How is that, Gollabhaama?

Aathai elaago chappu

Golla bhaama?

Gb: Allaagenayya;

Janmana jaiythe

Srodracha

Karmana jaiythe

Dhwijeha

Alright !

Meaqnings is same sloka – "Janamana jaaythe……"

Veda jainencha

Viprathwam

Bhrahma jnyaanena

Bhrahmanaha

Aa ayyavaru, janmane

Jaiethe soodraha:

Puteethappudu antharu

Soodrulugaane puttinaaru

Kathattaiya?

Karmane jaiyathe

Dhwijaha karamulu

Cheesaru kaapetti

Dhwijalainaaru

Vede jainencha

Viprathwam vedamulanu

Abhyasinchaaru kaapatti

Viprulainaar

Bhrahma jnyanena

Bhrahmanaha aa

Bhrahma jnyaanam

Evaru Sampaadincheero

Bhramanallu kaani,

Antha baapalu maattu

Kaarayya

V:Bhrahma gnyaanam

Ea kottlo dhoruguthunthi

Gollabhaama?

Oh revered! “Janmana-jaithe….” All are born as shoodras.
“Karmana…..” persons undertaking duties become Dhwijhas.
“Vede…..” persons who have learnt Vedas become, vedic scholars.
“Brahma….”, persons who have known the Supreme become, Brahmins.

In which shop will we get to buy this knowledge of the Supreme?

Gb:kottlo dorikke

Bhrahma jnyaanam

Kaadaya

Aa bhrama jnyaanam

A " "

This is not something that one can buy from the shops. That Bharma Jnaanam……

V: Aa bhrahma jnaana

Sampaadinchaal ante

Mattala Gollabhaame?

Kaalaani velinchaali

Samayam sariprodu

Maa pedaru

Vaalu cheeservu,

Vaalu mukthini

Pondaaru ippudu athani

Odilesammu

To attain that knowledge is it an easy task Gollabhaama? Now we don't have time for all that. Our ancestaors have done that and have attained salvation.

We have left all that now.

Abbrenation Used :-

(P) Pallavi

(AP) Anupallavi

(C) Charanam

(GB) Golla Bhama

(V) Viprilu - The Brahmin

Nirmala Spatikaakritham	-	Soft and pure white or flowless like the Sphtikam
Aadhaaram Sarvavidyanaam	–	Who is the base of all knowledge
Hayagreevamupasmahe.	–	I pray to the Lord Haingreeva

Vigneswara -sthuthi – Naata



Agajaanana Padmarkam	–	Parvathy is pleased like the lotus seeing the Sun
Gajananam aharnisam	–	Seeing Ganapathy day and night
Anaekadantham Bhakthanaam	–	The one who annihilates the sufferings of many devotees
Aekathadantham mupasmahe	–	I pray to the one who has only one tusk

Guru-sthuthi – Naata

Gurur Brahma	–	Guru is Lord Brahma
Gurur vishnum	–	Guru is Lord Vishum
Gurur devo Maheswarha	–	Guru is Lord Maheswara
Gurur shaakshaath Parabhramah	–	Guru is the the supreme Lord Parabhramah himself
Thasmayi Sree Guruve Namaha	–	That Guru, I do bow

Easwara Sthuthi (Kandhaartham) - Raagam Mohanam

Srisaila lingame

Charitha Kathaamritham	-	The nector-like story as it is told in history
Jeevanam Bahu jeenanampu	-	Is about life; an interesting life are worshiped in my mind and praying to the Gurus
Sangeetha Saahithya Sakala Vidyaluu Guruvu	-	Gurus of all knowledge like music,literature
Gananaayakunni Madani Gani Bhajinthu	-	bowing in front of the Lords among men
Kaavya Chanthambulu	-	The literature little knowledge
Gaana padhathilu	-	The ways of music
Theliya	-	known
Vyaasadi munilallelanu	-	Saints like Vyaasa and others
Mrokenu Kaalidaasadi	-	Bowing before Kalidasa's and others
Kavulu Kelanu	-	Literary works
Vaasiga sathgaanaadi	-	Verbally, good music
Vaasulu prasthuthimpa	-	Verses rendered
Bhoosuru varulanela	-	Bring before the Devas on the earth
Pogadina madilon	-	Praising them

Sandhi Vachanam - The dialogue from the background

Gnyaanaprabhothakamaina Golla Kalaapam Ettithaninaa - the scholarly Text of Golla Kalaapam is as follows

Daruvu Pravesa [Gollabhaama pravesa darusu] Saaranga Ragam, Atathaalam

(p)

Gollabhaama vochenu	-	Milkmaid comes
Paaloyani	-	With milk
Gollabhaama vochenu	-	Milkmaid comes
Perugoyani	-	with curd
Gollabhaama vochenu	-	Milkmaid comes
Chaloyani	-	with buttermilk

(AP)

Golla bhaama voche	-	Milkmaid comes
Pallana paani re	-	Buy and drink milk
Pallana aadanundi	-	From the place called pallanaadu
Chellalamu konuchu	-	Selling buttermilk

(Golla Bhaama…….

(C)

Thettaala theeyani	-	pure and sweet
Maathaalu chaakani	-	talks well
Bootula thoo sai	-	with cow herds
Yaattamullu aaduchu	-	she play along

Golla bootula_____
(Golla Bhaama……

(C)

Kaattuka kanulla	-	wide and beautiful eyes
Maattaalu saiyaga	-	says good things
Aaduchu leelatho	-	dances stories
Paataalu paadichi	-	sings songs

(Golla Bhaama ……

(C)

Kalakanti nila	-	Dreams like
Kunthalamu mereyaga	-	I am bright and beautiful
Thaliroboniro	-	young women - girls - lovely girls
Vinthalu maataladuchu	-	will tell you subjects that you dont know about
Molaka movitha	-	cute and small face
Jilukuchu nundanga	-	playfully undulating
Kaliki veedepumpu	-	attracts attention
Kulukku mohanaangi	-	me the Mohanaangi

(Golla Bhaama……..

Jathi

Tha tha kitta thaka tham
Tha kita thaka jham
Tha ka
Tha dhim kine tha ……(3)

Tha dhi kina tha ……..(9)

(C)

Mungivane cheera	-	the front piece of beautiful colorful saree
Chengula jaaraga	-	The top slips
Sangathulaoguchi	-	to let you know the subject
Kangu geethapuranga	-	the audience
Singaarinchuku	-	dressed up
Narasimha swamiki	-	lord Narasimha
Mukki	-	i bow
Pongiyaadava puri	-	praise the Yadava Cult
Rangani nagariki	-	the land of Lord Krishna

(Golla Bhaama…….

Slokam Bhoodevi sthuthi Naata

Vishnu sakthi samarpanee	-	I bow befor the power of Lord Vishnu
Chithravarne makheethale	-	Beautifu In myriad colours
Anaeke rathna sampanam	-	Rich with all kinds of gems
Bhoomi devi	-	I pray to the Godess Earth

Namosthuthe…… (3)

Samudra vasane devi	-	Devi who resides in the Oceans
Parvatha sthana mandala	-	Has bosom of mountains
Naatyamkarishye bhoodevi	-	We begin the dance; Oh! Devi ,
Paadaghatham ksamassvamme	-	Forgive me for the stampping

Sabhaa sthuthi raagam : ataana

Sarasulu sath kaneesmarullu	-	good me, who do good deeds
Sarvajagathananeeya sajaje Soo Bharithulu……..	-	Rich and powerful people in the society
Pandithoothamulu (2)	-	scholars
Pragnelulaina	-	assembled here
Mahaanubhavulu Lentharo kalari	-	ideal men all together
Sabhaa sthali	-	in the audience
Vinam brahmathi(2)	-	humbly
Thamalaelami	-	in front of
Namaskaranmulu	-	I bow
Aacharimpu manasaale	-	mentally
Kshmiyimpu thaappulunecho.	-	Forgive me if there are any mistakes

Maattallu (dialogues)

Viprudu:- eavitt golla

Bhama, Gollabhama

Gollabhaama Anttu ocheevu?

Asalu nee janma vruthantham

Eavitto? okaseeri savisthranga

Cheppu, Gollabhaama.

> What is this Gollabhaama,? You are calling yourself Gollabhaama and coming ? What is the mission in your life ? please explain in detail.

Gb:- Aa aayavaaru
Chepu chunaanu
Vinavaiyya

> Oh! The revered! I will explain please listen.

Padyam:- Ragam : Saarangi

Gola varaamu, golavaraamu, memu

V: eavitti Gollabhaama

Golavaraamu golavaraamu

Antunavvu ekkadaina

Aathinaaramu somavaraamu,

> What is this Gollabhama, you keep saying Yadava Cult etc. we have heard of days like Sunday, Monday, Tuesday etc. what is this Yadava Cult?

Mangalavaraamu, bhudha varammu,

Guruvaramu, shukravaraamu, shanni varaamu

Ainavaaramullu unai kaani,

E- golla varaamu anai,

Varaamu ekadaninchi

Vachinthi

Gollabhaama?

Padyam - Slokam

Gb Chandra vamsapu

Golla varaamu memu

V: Chandra vamsanu anna,

Soorya vamsannu anna,

Kshathreeyalullu

Chenthunthi kaani

Mee gollavallakku

Chenthunthaa Gollabhaama?

In the Moons' dynasty, was the Yadava cult.

The dynasty of Moon or Sun is applicable to the Kshathriyas? How is it applicable to you?

Slokam - Padyam

Masthya koorma

varaahaschya, narashimhaschya

vamanaha,raamo

ramashchya ramaschya,

budha Kalikame

vachaha.

Gb: Ani annaruganukka

V: mem vinaamuganukka

Gb:anaeka anatharamullu

Unttundaga, upaavatharamagu

Krishnanathaaramu

In the sloka, the ten incarnations (Dasaavathaara) of Lord Vishu are listed .

It is said so; right?

We have all heard of that

And, having this many Incarnations, as a sub-incarnation, when Lord Krishna was born, (we who belong to) the Yadava Cult also came into existence.

Eeppuddu puttinatho

Appudu putina

Gollavanarimayya memu

V: oh ho!

Appudu puttina

Golla nara meeru?

Thellisindh golla bhaama,

Inka savisthranga

Cheppu golla bhaama?

Oh ho!, so (you who belong to) the Yadava cult was born then? Ok. I understood. Please explain further Gollabhama.

Slokam - Padyam - Raagam Mohanam

Ksheerabdhi theeramanduna

Narayanudu amritharasamuna

Damarulakun, sthree roopu

Dalchi panchan

Naarimanulaaran

Neenu nadeebudithin

Like Lord Vishu took the form of Mohini to distribute the Amrutha after Amrutha was churned out of the ocean of milk, I am also entrusted with some erands / specific duties.

Maattullu

Gb: aa ayevaaru

Mupaimoodu koottala

Devathaallunu, aravidaaru

Koottala rakshasullunnu

Paalasamudrammu tharachina-

Naadu, aa samudra madhyamunundi

Alaahalanulu(1)

Airavathamunnu

Airavathamunnu(2)

Kaamadhennuvunnu

Oh! Revered, 33 crore devas and 66 crore asuras churned the ocean of milk. And, from the middle of that ocean many valubles, namely, Alaa-hal, Airavatham, Kaamadhenu, Kalpavrikshanam, Chinthamani, Chandra, Sri Mahalekshmi. After tha, (brought by Dhanwanthari) the Amrutam also came. To distribute that amruth among the devas and the asuras, Lord Vishu took the beautiful form of Mohini. Lord Brahma was surprised seeing this. Thus with lot of expectation he created me and named me Mohanangi.

Kalpavrikshanamumunu

Chinthamanniyunnu

Chandrudunnu

Sri mahalekshminuu

Mothalagu

Anneka sampathalu

Putina tharavatha

Danwantharitho

Aa amrithammu putunu

Aa amrithammunu

Devathalaku

Raakshasulukku

Panchuta kai

Vishnuvu

Kaanthaina vidhamu choochi

Bhrahma adbhutha aascharya mununtthi

Naanu srunjinchi

Naaku mohannagi

Ani naamam bidenu

V: Eamitti Gollabhama?

So Gollabhaama, do you mean to say that Lord Brahma after seeing the Mohini Avathara of Lord Vishu created you. If there it was Mohini, here it is Mohanangi? Understood, Gollabhama?

Sri Vishnu moorthi mohini

Avathaaram ethithe bhrahmagaaru

Adi choochi anthangantha

Andamayna yunathummu
Sreejjinchallani

Ninu srishtinchaara?

Akada mohiniaithe

Devadaasyam
Consecration to Art
National Kuchipudi workshop at
Naatyagruham
Kerala Sangeetha Nataka Academy,Thrissur
May 2 , 3 , 4 , 2013

Saalabhanjika
Studio for Arts & Performances

GOLLA KALAAPAM OR GOLLA NAATAKAM

Writtern By saint and poetess Maathrusri Tharigonda Vengamamba,
Iin the 18th century

Golla Kalaapam or the Golla Naatakam was written in the Yakshagana style. The text was performed by the touring Kuchipudi Bhagavathars as Vithi Bhagavathams , the street drama or discourses. It is believed that Sri Sidhendra yogi banned women from participating in such performances ; hence, the tradition became male dominated. It is said that the well trained and talented male performers could outlay any female performers on stage.

GOLLA – means the Goella or the Yadava caste .
and
KALAAPAM – means a dispute or an argument.

The Golla Kalaapam or the Golla Naatakam / Drama is the dispute or argument between the the milk maid (the , Golla Bhama) and the Brahmin Priest (,the Viprudu). These are the only two characters in this drama.
At the superficial level it is a dispute on the then prevalent caste system. The argument tries to establish the true Brahmin.
The crux line of this Nattakam is :- " JANMANA JAAYATHE SUDRAHA,
KARMANA JAYATHE DHWIJAHA,
VEDEDHAYANECHA VIPRATHWAM,
BRAHMA GNYAANENA BRAHMANAH."

The script has lots of sarcasm and wit in it. The language is a mixture of simple Telugu and Sanskrit. Despite his hard attemptes the Brahmin fails to win the argument. The milkmaid has a better knowledge of the vedas and the scriptures.

But, for a serious observer the " 'Golla Kalalapam" ' deals with total spirituality. It has episodes that deal with the real knowledge of The Supreme Being, in the introductory chapter known as the Viniki Ghattam or the Gollala Ghatam.
The second episode, the Yagnolpattu or the Yagna Ghattam deals with the life after death. This episode also talks on the importance of the rites and religious rituals of various social sectors.

The third episode, the Pindothpathi deals with the anatomical description of the womb, the gestation cycle and some aspects of embryology. It is observed that for some time this episode alone was performed in marriage ceremonies in the of some zamindars houses in Andhra Pradesh.

The last episode deals with Thripurasura Samhara. The content of this episode is the destruction of ego, ignorance and evil, which leads one to the ultimate truth.

Why was a milkmaid chosen to challenge a Brahmin, is a question that has been interpreted in many ways by many scholars. It is said that the milkmaid was chosen as a representative from the lower class of the society. It is also interpreted that, how a milkmaid makes curd, buttermilk, butter, ghee etc. from milk, are indicative of her capabities to explain the various interpretations to life. However, this aspect is not mentioned in the text .

Golla Kalaapam was originally written by The Saint Poetess Maathrusri Tharigonda Vengamamba in the 18th century. There has been descripting and rewriting of the original script ; hence, some different versions of Golla Kallapam was said to have existed. The next version, that's penned down and recorded was written by Paramaguru Bhagawathula Ramaih in the Kuchipidi Bhagawathula Sampradaya. The presentation of the drama in the Bhagawathula Sampradaya is different from the presentation in the Devadasi Sampradaya.
Tharigonda Vengamamba's script to date is followed with the same revere and spirit by the Devadasis, settled in the East Godavari District of Andhra Pradesh. Annabathula Buli Venkata Ratna Marepally sisters, viz. Vaidehi and Induvadana, from the Devadasi Family proved to be experts in the presentation of the aforesaid text. And, now the native version of the script is practiced and taught by Annabathula Lakshmi Mangatayaru.

The costumes used were bright or dark color silk sarees with silver borders. Jewelry was also in silver. The jewelry consisted of :

1. A single maati
2. A suryan(sun) on the right side and
3. A chandran (moon) on the left side
4. A pair of jhumkas
5. A pair of maati
6. A huge nose ring
7. A pair of snake like vangi or floral vangi
8. Glass or silver bangles
9. Finger rings
10. A necklace
11. A chain
12. A Odiyanam or the waist band with decorative strands
13. A pair of gajullu or the bells knotted on a string
14. A pair of anklets
15. A pair of Minji or toe rings
16. A hair pin flower

The hair was tied in a knot behind the neck with floral decorations around it.

A round bindi on the forehead is worn with decorations around that.

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